166. The Law Commission in 2008 recommended a common minimum marriage age of eighteen for both men and women. Full report available at: https://lawcommissionofindia.nic.in/reports/report205.pdf.

CHAPTER 18 'Party of Ram'

1. 'Danda-vat', a Sanskrit word, literally means lying on the floor like a stick. Devotees perform dandvat pranam by lying fully prostrate on the floor with their arms stretched out. It is a symbol of complete submission. The full video of Modi's dandvat pranam before the Ram Lalla idol in Ayodhya on 5 August 2020 is available at: https://navbharattimes.indiatimes.com/state/uttar-pradesh/ayodhya/faizabad/narendra-modi-offers-prayers-to-ram-lalla-in-ayodhya-before-ram-mandir-bhumi-pujan/videoshow/77366857.cms.
2. For critiques of the Ayodhya bhoomi-pujan, see, for instance, Yogendra Yadav, 'Secularism gave up language of religion. Ayodhya Boomi Pujan is a result of that', *The Print*, 5 August 2020, https://theprint.in/opinion/secularism-language-religion-ayodhya-bhoomi-pujan-ram-mandir-kashmir/475307/; Pratap Bhanu Mehta, 'Ram, I will not find you there', *The Indian Express*, 5 August 2020. For a counter-view, see Ram Madhav, 'Great unifier, universal hero', *The Indian Express*, 5 August 2020, and Vinay Sahasrabuddhe, 'Temple as turning point', *The Indian Express*, 5 August 2020.
3. 'Suratrana' is a Sanskrit term which literally is interpreted to mean protector/saviour of the gods or as a transliteration of the word 'Sultan' into Sanskrit. It featured, among other places, in an inscription on the Qutab Minar in Delhi, coins of the early Delhi Sultanate sultans and inscriptions of the Vijayanagar empire in Hampi and several other places. The copper plates of Devaraya II of the Vijayanagara kingdom use the term 'Hinduraya Suratrana'. For details on the Qutab Minar inscription, see Sheldon Pollock, 'Ramayana and political imagination in India', *The Journal of Asian Studies*, Vol. 52, No. 2, May 1993, p. 285; for the origins of the term, see A.R. Kulkarni, 'Social relations in the Maratha period